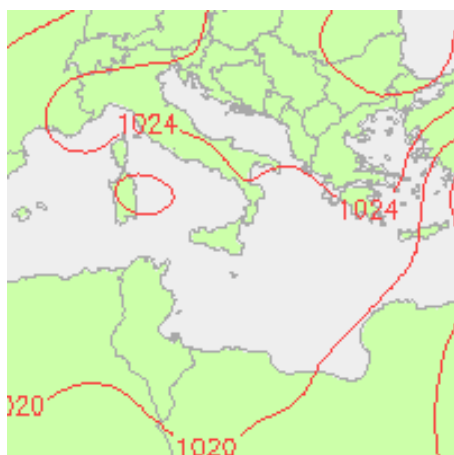


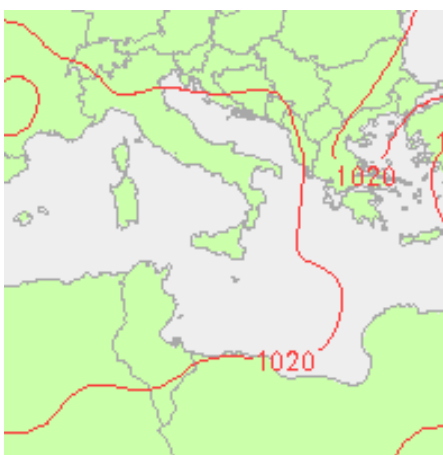
Date: October /18th /2014
Time: 07:40 AM (05:40 UTC)
Event: MIDDLE SEA RACE 2013
Boat: B2



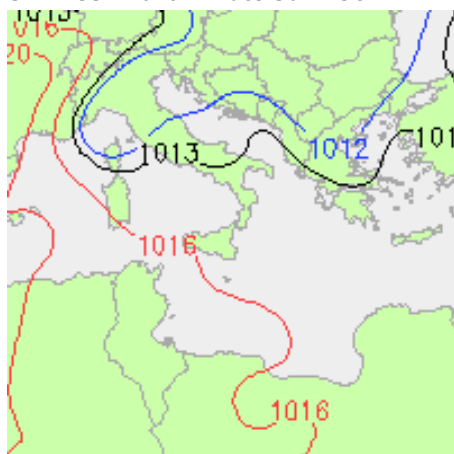
Synopsis: High pressures on the Western and Central Mediterranean on Saturday until Monday. Powerful Low over Central Europe and secondary Low over Italy and the Adriatic on Tuesday and deepening on Wednesday. This Low will cause strong Mistral on the western Mediterranean reaching this region as fresh to strong Northwesterlies.



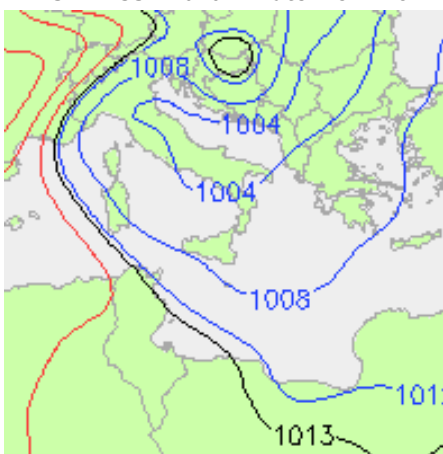
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sun 19th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Mon 20th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Tue 21st



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Wed 22nd

WARNINGS: Possible Gale Force gusts (34-40 kts) during Wednesday afternoon until Thursday early morning.

Forecast along the course

Summary:

-High pressures and weak gradient apparently leading to a slow and long race until Monday; moderate breeze increasing to strong on Tuesday and Wednesday.

-Warm temperatures and sunny or partly sunny skies most of the time, Temperatures not less than 20° even in the NW fresh breeze; apparently no chance of rain until Wednesday evening when there is some chance of showers .

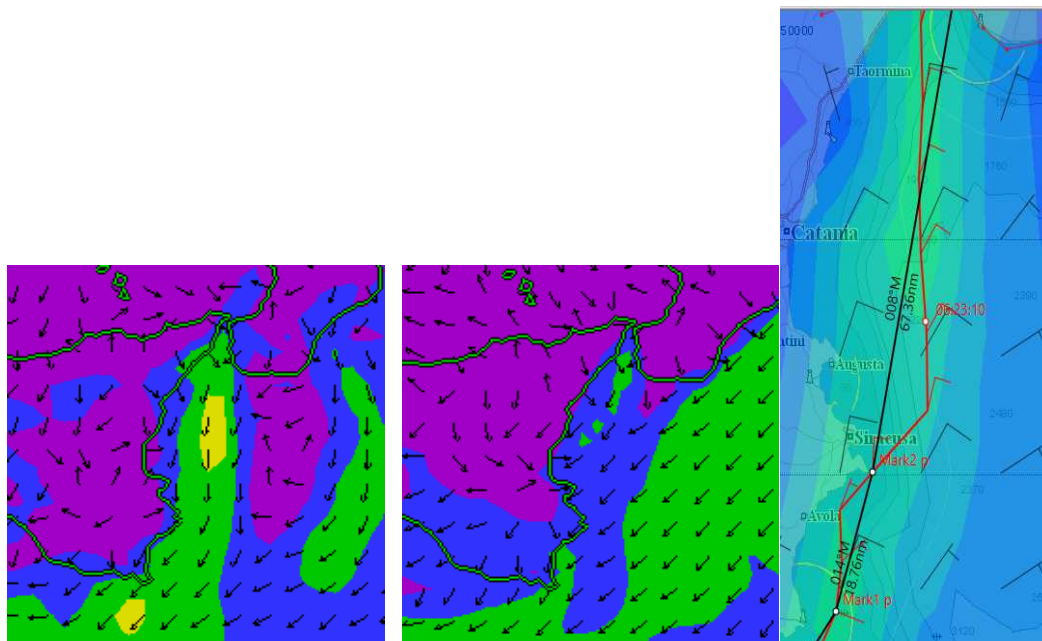
-Routings with our models are showing by the moment an estimated time of arrival on Wednesday morning.

Malta to Portopalo (SE Sicily) 11-18 h

This first leg can be sailed with NW (280 backing to 260°) between 5-8 kts increasing to 10-13 kts but dropping close Sicily before the big shift to north.

Portopalo to Messina Strait 18 to 09 h

Tricky leg as there can be a “tube” of more pressure coming from the Strait. Very dangerous to get trapped close to the Sicilian coast. There is some veering to 030°s expected in the early morning, backing to north in the morning. Our routing is suggesting to do a tack on port when the twd is less than 020° to get the pressure and the later trend.



Sunday 02 h

Sunday 08 h

Routing and wind field 01 h

We can reach Messina Strait on Sunday morning, let's say between 08-10 h. Once there the wind will probably drop to variable light breeze, 3-6 kts predominating southerly direction, so in our scenario will should be able to cross the Strait with the northwards current, leaving it around 17 h.

Sunday the changes of tidal stream should be

Southwards current (*scendente*) between 0400 h and 1110 h, and between 1640 h and 0020 h (Monday).

Northwards current (*montante*) between 1110 and 1640 h.

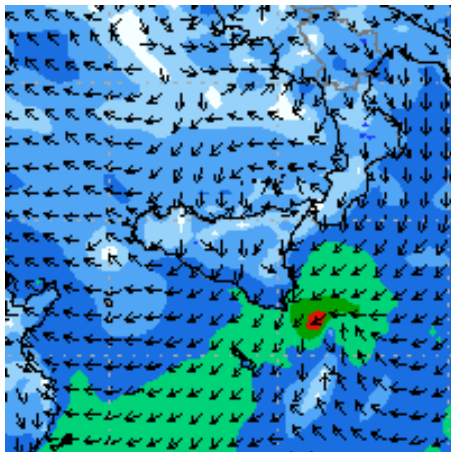
Some delay in reaching the Strait can be amplified as it means facing the southwards current.

Strait to Stromboli 17 h to 04 h (Monday)

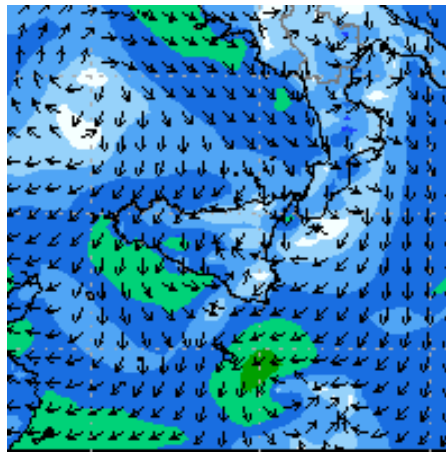
Very light breeze in this leg, let's say from 3 to 6 kts, mainly from south or SE direction, but with so light speed models can be very inaccurate. So it's a run, Let's assume that we'll be at Stromboli between 04-08 h on Monday morning.

Stromboli to San Vito lo Capo 04 h (Monday) to 09 h (Tuesday)

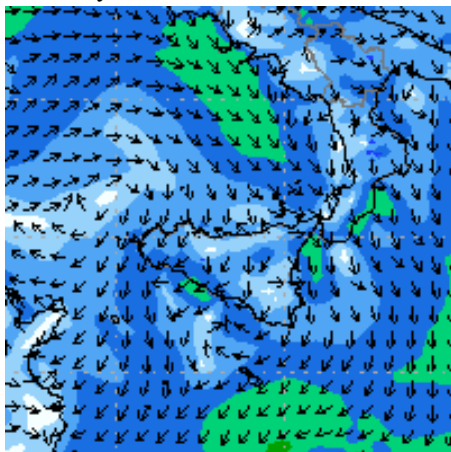
Models are very inconsistent on the wind patterns and so for the timing of this long leg. My main option would be prevailing breeze from N or NE 5-10 kts during the day, helped by the Sicilian land heating. The wind during Tuesday night is not well defined, it can be either very light and variable direction all night long OR the northerly breeze backs gradually towards the westerly expected to arrive, as showed by Lamma; this option would be much faster.



Monday 08 h

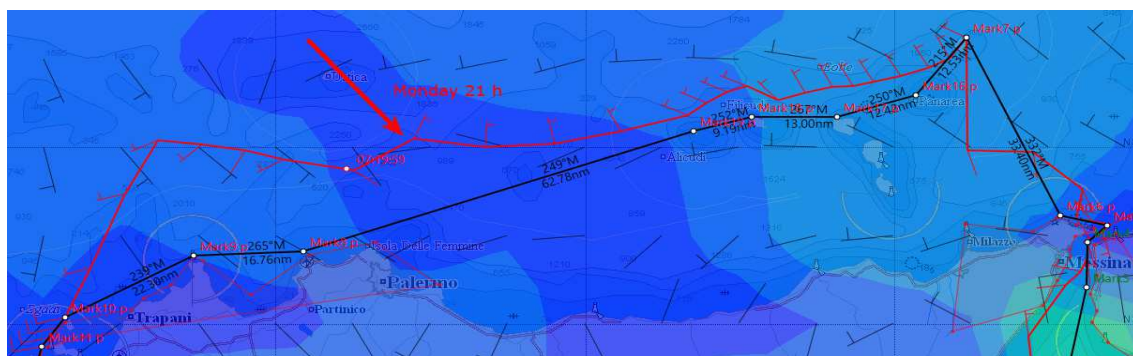


Monday 20 h



Tuesday 02 h

Our routing is suggesting to do a route pretty much north than the direct course:



(wind field is for Tuesday 02 h blue arrows, ECMWF model)

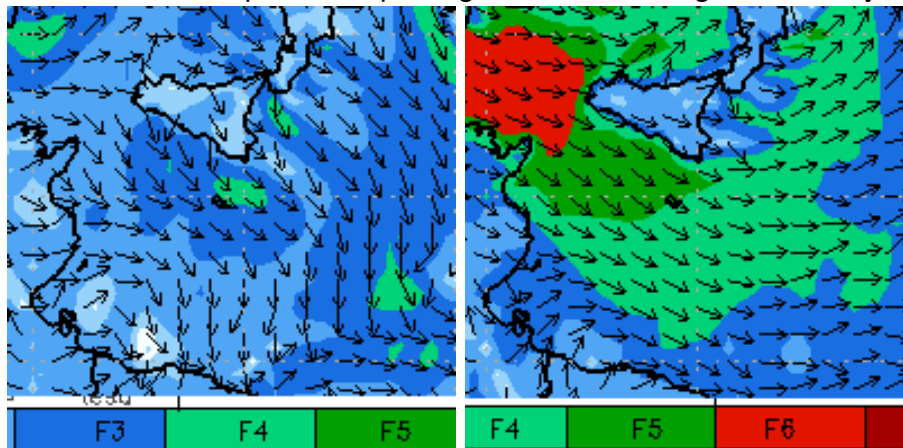
We could think that with this light gradient, choosing a route close to the land can make use of the night land breezes. Could work, but the concern is that at that shores there are cliffs that can get a boat trapped for some hours... Apparently dangerous.

By the moment we'll assume reaching San Vito Lo Capo on Tuesday around early morning or morning.

San Vito lo Capo - Favignana – Pantelleria - Lampedusa – Finish

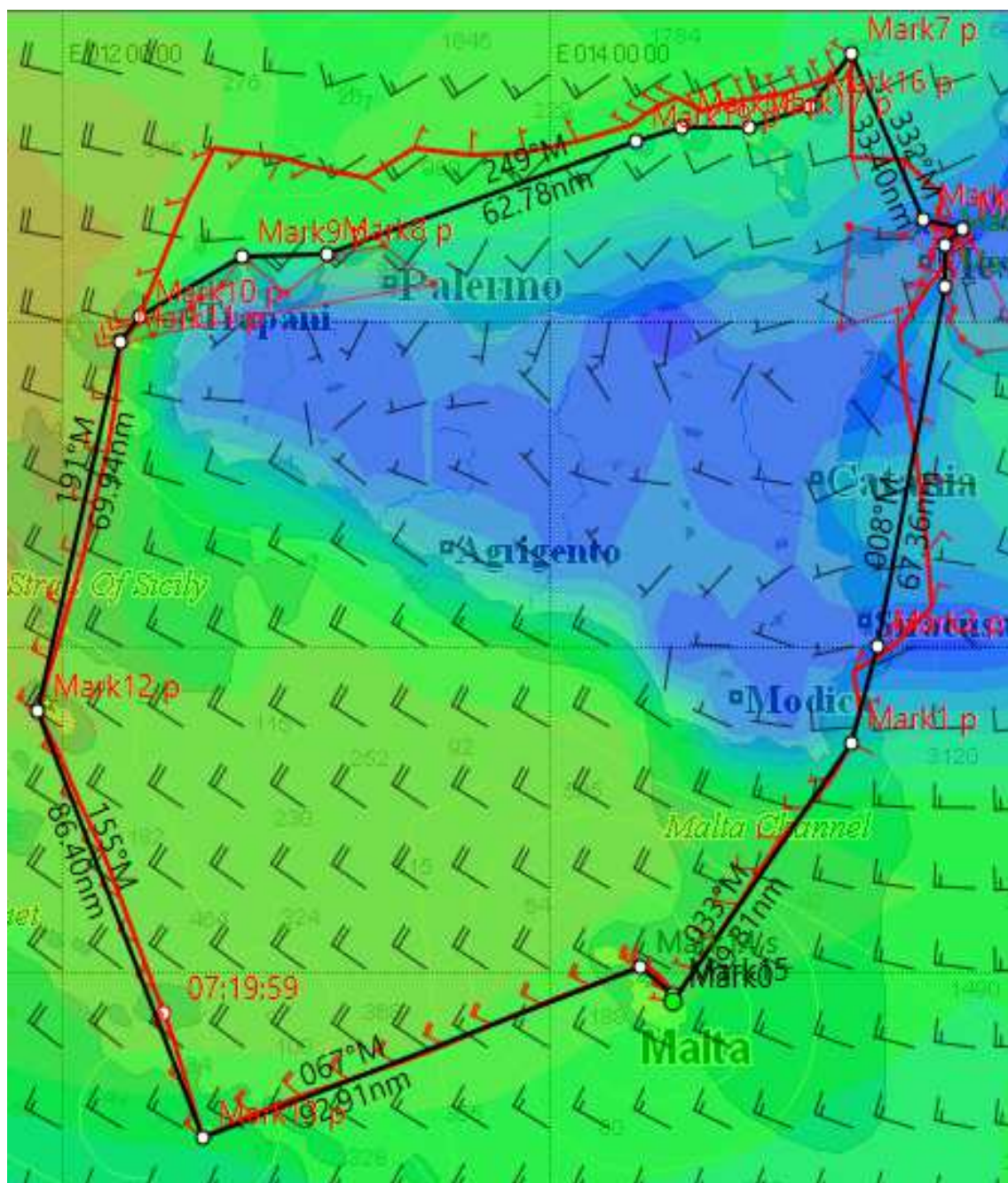
Westerly gradient should fill in on Tuesday morning, initially from SW or WSW, veering gradually to W and NW, max right can be some 300-310 at Lampedusa in the early morning of Wednesday. Expect the wind speed increasing steadily; let's say some 10 kts at Favignana (14 h Tuesday), some 15 kts at Pantelleria (21 h), some 20 kts at Lampedusa (04 h Wednesday), 25 kts going to the finish with strong gusts.

Strategy on these legs is over, just direct routes except slightly eastwards route from Pantelleria to Lampedusa expecting some 10° veering... Not totally reliable, however.



Tuesday 08 h

Wednesday 02h



Total routing and Wind field ECMWF Wednesday 22 at 02 h

Estimated time of arrival around Wednesday morning.